

英検準1級 リーディング問題

2023年度 第3回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

ReadPassで復習

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(25)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(1) The factories in the valley are a major source of environmental pollution. Their chimneys (1) thick black smoke into the atmosphere.

- 1 ascribe 2 emit 3 rattle 4 allocate

(2) Rainforests are disappearing faster than ever, but many environmental groups are working to save them from being (2) by agriculture.

- 1 interpreted 2 facilitated 3 reprimanded 4 devastated

(3) Carly (3) over the decision about whether to accept the new job. She knew it would be a huge benefit to her career, but she did not want to move to another city.

- 1 agonized 2 delighted 3 expanded 4 generated

(4) The hotel has a swimming pool, free Internet access, large flat-screen TVs, and many other (4).

- 1 entrepreneurs 2 amenities 3 leftovers 4 receptacles

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q11

次の(1)から(25)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (5) The discovery of a 2,000-year-old clay pot provided valuable (5) into the city's ancient past. Historians said the pot gave them important clues about how people used to live.
- 1 misery 2 insight 3 hassle 4 literacy
- (6) When she first became famous, the actor loved the media attention she received. Soon, however, she grew tired of reporters (6) on her private life.
- 1 deforming 2 investing 3 discarding 4 intruding
- (7) The mayor announced that in the (7) of the huge storm, government offices and schools would be closed until the town was cleaned up.
- 1 treaty 2 inclusion 3 fortune 4 aftermath
- (8) As Kiernan hiked along the mountain (8), he could see that there was a large lake to the east, and that the valley to the west was covered mostly by forest.
- 1 pledge 2 ridge 3 quota 4 stock
- (9) Cathy felt (9) after lunch, so she drank some coffee to help her stay awake for the rest of the day.
- 1 rigid 2 notable 3 acute 4 drowsy
- (10) All the staff members at the hotel are very (10), so famous people who book rooms there know that nothing about their stays will be told to the media.
- 1 discreet 2 artificial 3 realistic 4 temporary
- (11) Hundreds of fans waited for hours outside the band's hotel hoping to get even a brief (11) of the famous rock stars.
- 1 couch 2 sip 3 glimpse 4 pinch

大問1 語彙・文法 Q12-Q18

次の(1)から(25)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (12) **A:** I'm glad you finally made it, Carl. Did you receive any (12) from the airline because your flight was canceled?
B: Well, they paid for a hotel for the night, but that's all.
- 1 glances 2 fabric 3 installations 4 compensation
- (13) Killing another human being is generally considered to be a crime unless it is (13), as in the case of self-defense.
- 1 adjacent 2 justified 3 integral 4 peculiar
- (14) For people trying to lose weight, many doctors advise choosing (14) meats, such as chicken breast, over meats that are fatty.
- 1 sacred 2 grim 3 sheer 4 lean
- (15) KBC is an organization that helps children who lost their parents. It helps these (15) find new homes where they can be well cared for.
- 1 orphans 2 phases 3 leases 4 allies
- (16) The man (16) himself in the crime when he lied about where he was on the night of the murder.
- 1 discriminated 2 implicated 3 eliminated 4 constrained
- (17) While borrowing books is free, most libraries will charge a late fee for those that are (17).
- 1 furious 2 bilateral 3 potent 4 overdue
- (18) John and Tina made the (18) decision to end their relationship. Neither one was happy, and they both wanted to start dating other people.
- 1 monetary 2 judicial 3 mutual 4 indifferent

大問1 語彙・文法 Q19-Q25

次の(1)から(25)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (19) Before cooking a potato, its skin should be (19) with a fork. This lets steam escape from the small holes, preventing the potato from exploding.
1 pierced 2 radiated 3 ceased 4 rejected
- (20) After trimming the tree, the men gathered up the cut branches and placed them all in one big (20).
1 bid 2 heap 3 vice 4 grain
- (21) In English, the (21) form of a noun is usually created by adding an "s" to the end of it. However, there are some exceptions, like "feet" and "mice."
1 empirical 2 fiscal 3 verbal 4 plural
- (22) As the man walked up into the hills, the noises of the city began to (22) until the only thing he could hear was the birds singing.
1 die away 2 rub down 3 back out 4 call off
- (23) Scientists have yet to (23) an exact cause for food allergies, but they believe that both genetics and the environment play a role.
1 see out 2 pin down 3 juice up 4 book in
- (24) The manager interviewed several applicants, but he has yet to find someone who (24) to his standards for the job.
1 sends off 2 measures up 3 knuckles down 4 sums up
- (25) Laura thought the dog looked friendly, so she walked toward it. She (25) in shock, however, when it started barking at her.
1 drew back 2 made up 3 pulled through 4 cooled off

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q26-Q28

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(26)から(31)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Bears and Diabetes

Grizzly bears, which can be found in the western United States, Canada, and Alaska, hibernate during the coldest part of the year. In preparation for this period of inactivity, the bears behave in a way that (26). To build up necessary fat reserves in the months leading up to hibernation, the bears increase their daily food consumption to around 20,000 calories and they gain over three kilograms of body weight per day. In humans, excessive consumption is the prime cause of a condition known as Type 2 diabetes, which can lead to blindness, heart attacks, and strokes.

Hundreds of millions of people worldwide suffer from Type 2 diabetes. As in many animals, the human body regulates sugar levels by producing a hormone called insulin, which controls how much sugar is absorbed into the body's cells from the blood. Type 2 diabetes develops when high blood sugar levels over a long period - often due to overconsumption - cause the body's cells to become resistant to the effects of insulin. (27), the body can no longer adjust sugar levels.

A recent study at the University of Washington may help to explain why grizzly bears do not get Type 2 diabetes. According to one of the study's leaders, it seems that the bears are able to regulate resistance to insulin. The study suggests this process is controlled by eight proteins, which (28). It is hoped a greater understanding of this process in bears could lead to improved treatments for Type 2 diabetes in humans.

(26)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|-------------------------------|---|----------------------------------|---|--|---|-----------------------------|
| 1 | scientists cannot yet explain | 2 | can lead to environmental damage | 3 | would likely cause health problems in humans | 4 | sometimes puts them at risk |
|---|-------------------------------|---|----------------------------------|---|--|---|-----------------------------|

(27)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|---------------|---|--------------|---|--------------|---|-------------|
| 1 | Alternatively | 2 | Despite this | 3 | For instance | 4 | As a result |
|---|---------------|---|--------------|---|--------------|---|-------------|

(28)

- | | | | | | | | |
|---|---------------------------------------|---|--------------------------|---|--------------------------------|---|------------------------------------|
| 1 | grizzly bears do not create naturally | 2 | are also found in humans | 3 | cause Type 2 diabetes in bears | 4 | are responsible for other diseases |
|---|---------------------------------------|---|--------------------------|---|--------------------------------|---|------------------------------------|

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q29-Q31

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(26)から(31)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Secrets of the Argonaut

Female argonaut octopuses are known for their beautiful shells. In the early 1920s, zoologist Adolf Naef theorized that the shell had evolved to protect the argonaut's eggs after mating, but he also argued that it negatively impacted the creature's chances of survival. This was because air bubbles often became trapped in the shells, causing the octopuses to rise to the surface, where Naef thought they were more likely to be consumed by predators. However, Naef (29). Modern research has confirmed that although Naef's theory about the protective nature of the shell was accurate, the air bubbles do indeed serve a beneficial function.

In an experiment, researchers dropped three female argonauts into the sea. All three swam to the surface and appeared to intentionally allow air into their shells. They then moved back down and were able to maintain their vertical positions in the ocean without swimming or making any other apparent effort. This seems to be because the pressure from the air in their shells balanced out their body weight. It therefore appears that the shells (30).

The researchers also believe that Naef was mistaken about the shells making argonauts more likely to be eaten by predators near the ocean surface. Argonauts spend a brief time in shallow waters because they only rise to take in air. After quickly descending, they are able to control how far they dive. (31), this gives argonauts a considerable advantage over other octopus species. While most are limited to hunting on the ocean floor, argonauts can search for prey at a wide variety of depths.

(29)

- 1 denied the air bubble theory 2 also made another prediction 3 had been confused by the eggs 4 was only partially correct

(30)

- 1 are damaged by bubbles 2 are lighter than they appear 3 help them save energy 4 actually frighten predators

(31)

- 1 In fact 2 Regardless 3 For one thing 4 In exchange

大問3A 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ32-Q34に答えなさい。

A Daring Escape

Robert Smalls was born in South Carolina in the United States in 1839, a time when slavery was common. He was the son of an enslaved woman, and when he was still only a boy, his mother persuaded her owner to send Smalls to work on the docks in Charleston City, believing her son would be safer there. Smalls later married an enslaved woman and had two children, but he constantly feared they would be sold to a different owner and he would never see them again. He was unable to raise enough money to buy his family's freedom, so escape became the only option.

In 1861, the American Civil War began between President Abraham Lincoln's Union forces and the southern Confederate States. The Confederates controlled Charleston, and because of his experience working on the docks, Smalls was taken to work on a Confederate ship that carried supplies of weapons and ammunition. This created a situation that gave Smalls the opportunity he had been waiting for. The captain of the ship often went ashore at night, leaving Smalls and the other enslaved crew members alone on the ship. Smalls persuaded the other crew members to join him in a daring escape.

Smalls's plan was risky, however. First, he and the rest of the crew had to pick up Smalls's family and leave the harbor without being discovered by Confederate guards. If they managed this, they still risked being fired on by the Union Navy, which had formed a blockade around the harbor to prevent Confederate ships from leaving. Fortunately, during his time working on the ship, Smalls had learned the signals for gaining safe passage through Confederate checkpoints. Once the ship was out of the harbor, he lowered its Confederate flag and replaced it with a white flag of surrender to discourage the Union ships from attacking. The escape was successful, and Smalls not only gained freedom for his family but was also paid half the value of the ship he handed over.

大問3A 長文設問 Q32-Q34

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

(32) According to the first paragraph, what is true about Robert Smalls?

- 1 He was forced to go to Charleston to prevent his mother from being harmed by the man who owned her.
- 2 He was concerned that he would be separated from his wife and children forever if they were bought by a different owner.
- 3 He earned enough money to buy freedom for his family, but his owner refused to let them go.
- 4 He took his family to live in Charleston because he thought it was a safe place to raise his children.

(33) When the American Civil War began, Smalls

- 1 persuaded the Confederates to let him work on one of its ships so that he could use the ship to get back to his hometown.
- 2 lost his job on the docks because the Confederates no longer had a need for enslaved workers.
- 3 was made to work on a ship that was used by the Confederates to transport weapons needed to fight the civil war.
- 4 gained favor with the Confederates by helping them find a way to get their ships out of Charleston harbor.

(34) What was one factor that helped Smalls escape with his family?

- 1 He had managed to obtain a Union flag, which he raised to prevent the Union Navy from attacking his ship.
- 2 His knowledge of the harbor allowed him to find a route that avoided Confederate guards.
- 3 He had friends in the Union Navy who were sympathetic to his situation and helped him get out of the harbor.
- 4 His experience had taught him how to trick the Confederate checkpoints into letting his ship pass safely.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ35-Q37に答えなさい。

The Bet

In 1980, environmentalist Paul Ehrlich and economist Julian Simon made a bet about the future of mankind. Ehrlich predicted that population growth and increased demand for goods would put a strain on limited resources, leading to starvation and catastrophe. Simon, however, did not share Ehrlich's pessimism, arguing that human creativity and intelligence would allow society to obtain the necessary resources or find alternatives. The purpose of the bet, therefore, was to show whose theory was correct. Since Ehrlich's side of the argument was far more familiar to the general public, Simon hoped the bet would attract attention to his side. He bet \$1,000 that in a decade, the price of five commonly used metals, including copper and nickel, would be lower. These were chosen because they were often used for manufacturing essential goods and seemed certain to be in short supply if Ehrlich's prediction was correct.

Ten years later, Simon won - prices of the metals fell by around 50 percent overall when adjusted for inflation. However, economists say that, to some extent, Simon got lucky. If different materials or starting times had been chosen, there would have been numerous scenarios where Simon ended up paying Ehrlich. In the 1990s, for example, factors like the collapse of Communist governments in Eastern Europe led to substantial declines in raw material prices, and in the years following, they tended to rise due to the recovery of the formerly Communist economies and reductions in supply. Therefore, there would have been a large increase in prices over ten years if the bet had been delayed. It is now generally agreed that Simon was correct overall, however, and would inevitably win on a longer timescale.

Today, Ehrlich's prediction has failed to become reality. Thanks to technology, when population growth increases demand for materials, improvements in production methods tend to counter its effects, or substitutes are found. While this seems like positive news, there are worries about the impact of debates like Ehrlich and Simon's. The fact that technology appears to have lessened the effects of population growth is often taken as evidence that humans will also be able to overcome environmental problems in the same way. This is not necessarily the case, however, as the climate crisis shows. Furthermore, the fact that environmental debates are set out in the same way, with extreme warnings of catastrophe, such as global warming, being countered by incredibly optimistic predictions, tends to make constructive dialogue impossible and divide people into two opposing camps.

大問3B 長文設問 Q35-Q37

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (35) Julian Simon bet Paul Ehrlich \$1,000 because
- 1 he did not think that the prices of certain essential goods were related to the prices of things like common metals.
 - 2 he believed that the price of the metals would not be affected even if they became rare due to the increased demand.
 - 3 he wanted to demonstrate that increases in population would not result in serious shortages of the materials that humans needed to live.
 - 4 he did not accept the idea that the world's population was going to increase as much as Ehrlich predicted it would.

- (36) What is implied in the second paragraph about the bet between Simon and Ehrlich?
- 1 The specific metals and the time period that were chosen for the bet seem to have had an effect on the result.
 - 2 Although the prices of a few metals did decrease, Ehrlich was correct about the increasing shortages due to population growth.
 - 3 It demonstrated that neither Ehrlich nor Simon was actually correct about the long-term trends that were occurring.
 - 4 Simon would still have won, even if the governments of countries in Eastern Europe had not had problems in the 1990s.

- (37) According to the author of the passage, what impact do debates like the one between Simon and Ehrlich seem to have had on modern society?
- 1 They have made it clear that finding alternatives to common metals will become important in the very near future.
 - 2 They have made people realize that the way common metals are used has more effect on the environment than had previously been known.
 - 3 They have increased debates about how current population increases are going to affect the supply of necessary materials in the future.
 - 4 They have influenced the way that people see modern environmental problems and made it more difficult to have meaningful communication about them.

大問3C 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ38-Q41に答えなさい。

Meritocracy

Meritocracy, a system in which people are rewarded based on talent and effort rather than class or wealth, is widely regarded as an ideal basis for a fair society. Efforts to implement this system in the United States began with noble intentions as institutions, such as elite universities and large corporations, realized that wealthy white males enjoyed an unreasonable degree of privilege. The institutions sought to make themselves more accessible to females, minorities, and people from working-class backgrounds. While these attempts initially led to improved admission and hiring rates for disadvantaged people, there are indications that people with higher incomes have come up with ways to gain an unfair share of educational opportunities. Access to superior schools and private tutoring, after all, greatly increases the odds that their children will be admitted to an elite university, which in turn enhances their earning potential. Although things like college scholarships for minorities may create the illusion of fairness, meritocracy can often be manipulated.

Furthermore, it appears that attempts to implement meritocracy can be problematic. In one disturbing psychological experiment, managers were shown statements about a company's values and then instructed to decide on bonus payments for employees. In cases where the statements emphasized that the company was a meritocracy, subjects awarded larger amounts to males than they did to females with identical performance evaluations. When shown statements that did not mention meritocracy, however, this phenomenon did not appear. It has been suggested that this reflects the belief that operating in an organization that emphasizes it is a meritocracy makes people neglect to examine their own behavior, and without this self-assessment, they are more likely to show bias.

Critics of meritocracy, such as legal scholar Daniel Markovits, suggest that it even has negative effects on the elite. America's wealthy were once known as the "leisure class" because their inheritances and investments allowed them to devote most of their time to recreation. Now, however, as Markovits writes, "those who manage to claw their way to the top must work with crushing intensity." They are constantly monitored and assessed, and if their performance slips, they face the threat of demotion or firing. People in the middle and lower classes are also constantly struggling to move up or maintain their position, and there is so much pressure from the fear that others will take one's place that it seems to be having an effect on people's psychological well-being in all levels of society.

America has long had a reputation as an immigrant nation where anyone, regardless of race or social class, could become wealthy, and surveys indicated that most Americans believed that intelligence and hard work were the primary factors that led to success. In recent years, however, surveys have indicated that some two-thirds of Americans are coming to accept that the nation's wealthy hold their position due to advantages gained early in life, while just one-third attribute the wealthy's success mainly to hard work. Furthermore, seven in ten Americans now view poverty as the result of obstacles that people have faced in life rather than a lack of effort.

大問3C 長文設問 Q38-Q41

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (38) What point does the author of the passage make about education in the first paragraph?
- 1 Efforts to ensure that a wider range of students are able to attend elite universities have not always been successful.
 - 2 Although efforts at instituting meritocracy were unsuccessful at first, great progress has been made recently.
 - 3 Efforts to make education more open to a wide variety of people have been more effective than efforts to open up companies.
 - 4 Bringing the ideal of meritocracy to universities cannot be done unless it first comes to ordinary schools.
- (39) What is one possible reason for people's behavior in the experiment introduced in the second paragraph?
- 1 Belief in meritocracy can cause managers to evaluate male employees more harshly than they deserve.
 - 2 Meritocracies seem to cause significant declines in the job performance of both male and female employees.
 - 3 Trying to use financial rewards to encourage belief in meritocracy can have the completely opposite effect.
 - 4 People are less likely to be aware of their own prejudices when they believe the company is a meritocracy.
- (40) According to Daniel Markovits, one disadvantage of meritocracy is that
- 1 wealthy people have found unfair ways to ensure that they continue to maintain their position without working hard.
 - 2 the methods that are usually used to evaluate workers are often unfair, especially to members of the upper class.
 - 3 it has created a sense of constant competition that can have negative effects on people's mental health.
 - 4 the amount of resentment between members of different social classes has grown significantly because of it.
- (41) How have American views on meritocracy changed?
- 1 More people have come to recognize that when people are poor, it may not necessarily be their fault.
 - 2 It has caused people to change their views regarding how many immigrants should be allowed into the country.
 - 3 People are slowly beginning to lose their prejudices against members of other races and social classes.
 - 4 There is more recognition of the effort that wealthy people have made to achieve their high status in life.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。 大問3は正解番号のみを表示しています。



Q01-Q14		Q15-Q28		Q29-Q41	
Q01	2	Q15	1	Q29	4
emit		orphans		was only partially correct	
Q02	4	Q16	2	Q30	3
devastated		implicated		help them save energy	
Q03	1	Q17	4	Q31	1
agonized		overdue		In fact	
Q04	2	Q18	3	Q32	2
amenities		mutual			
Q05	2	Q19	1	Q33	3
insight		pierced			
Q06	4	Q20	2	Q34	4
intruding		heap			
Q07	4	Q21	4	Q35	3
aftermath		plural			
Q08	2	Q22	1	Q36	1
ridge		die away			
Q09	4	Q23	2	Q37	4
drowsy		pin down			
Q10	1	Q24	2	Q38	1
discreet		measures up			
Q11	3	Q25	1	Q39	4
glimpse		drew back			
Q12	4	Q26	3	Q40	3
compensation		would likely cause health problems in humans			
Q13	2	Q27	4	Q41	1
justified		As a result			
Q14	4	Q28	2		
lean		are also found in humans			

学習記録

得点 _____ / 41

やり直す問題 _____

メモ _____